
UNIT 14 EDUCATIONAL MEDIA

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14.0 INTRODUCTION

You may agree that there are two ‘M’s which are dominating today’s world. One ‘M’ stands for ‘Money’ while another ‘M’ stands for ‘Media’. But interestingly, without using ‘Media’, no economy in any part of the world would be able to survive. It may be ‘Print Media’ like News Papers, Magazines or ‘Electronic Media’ like Radio, Television or Film or ‘New Media’ like Internet or ‘Social Media’ like Face Book, WhatsApp, Twitter and so on, but we know that each type of ‘Media’ plays a significant role in life. But it is also true that till date, media has not made that impact to the extent Thomas Edison had predicted once, way back in 1922:

“I believe that the motion picture is destined to revolutionize our educational system and that in a few years it will supplant largely, if not entirely, the use of textbooks.....The education of the future, as I see it, will be conducted through the medium of the motion picture... THOMAS EDISON.” (Cuban, 1986, p.9).

Have you ever heard of ‘Educational Media’? Which media do you think is Educational? Is it an Audio or Video Programme or Radio or Television Broadcast or a Video Clip on YouTube? But has it anything to do with the usefulness of media in education (or learning)? What are the best ways to use Educational Media in the Classroom and beyond classroom?

In this unit, we will discuss at length- how media has made an impact in the field of education.

14.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After reading this unit, you will be able to:

- describe the evolution of Educational Media;
- analyse the role of Educational Media in India;
- describe the use of Educational Media in Teaching and Learning;
- describe innovative use of Educational Media; and
- analyse the future of Educational Media in the Era of Convergence of ICT.

14.2 EVOLUTION OF EDUCATIONAL MEDIA

Among a wide spectrum of Media like Print and Non-Print (Electronic Media) available to us, what could be the basis of judging a newspaper or a video programme or any other medium as Educational Media? It would be proper to know the answers of few related questions before entering the world of Educational Media. These questions could be, for example: What should we mean by Educational Media? How do we perceive it? How should we define it?

14.2.1 Educational Media: Definitions and Perceptions

‘Educational Media’ is any type of media (Print/Electronic/New) used to educate someone on a specific subject. Educational media can either be used at home or in the classroom to supplement or complement some lessons. Educational Media, for example, could be a Television Documentary or an Audio programme. But does it mean that it should only educate someone or it may also instruct or enrich the learner/audience? According to Finn Ryan “A lot of media used in classroom settings is more instructional”. Educational media is more about engagement than transfer of information.”

A large number of different types of media may be covered under Educational Media and we may put them under few major categories like Text, Still Images, Audio, Video and Multi-media. Text is the most common type of educational media and it includes Text Books, Worksheets and Written Notes. A diary can be considered as educational media because it educates the student on the lifestyle, belief and attitude of the person who wrote it. Similarly, a Textbook may be useful for summarising and explaining content. Still images, included in textbooks, are another common educational media which include photographs, sketches, graphs and charts. They provide learners a visual reference to the topic/concept covered in the lesson. Similarly, Audio and video are useful for aural and visual aspects respectively as far as their authenticity is concerned. Documentaries and movies can both be educational media, subject to the content of the course. Audio

includes recorded speeches/talk, readings of text interviews, opinions, debate/discussion and so on. Music (Vocal/Instrumental), sound effects like chirping of birds or horn of a motor car etc. can also be included in educational media if they are relevant for the course. While Music is essential for music classes speeches / talks help students listen to the tone of the speaker and feel the emotions and Text Readings which are often used in English literature classes. Therefore, Educational Media may be defined as media whose components can be integrated into learning experiences.

14.2.2 Educational Media vs. Educational Technology

What is the difference between educational media and educational technology? 'Educational Media' are Text Books, Magazines, Film, Audio/Video Programmes where as 'Technology' includes Computer, TV, Digital Cameras and so on. But Media and Technology are interdependent. We expect you as a student to acquire few important technological and communication skills like "ear mindedness" in the case of radio, as well as speaking, writing, and production techniques to exploit the strength of each medium for their benefit.

14.2.3 Educational Media–Its Evolution

Each one of us is exposed to media in our daily life. You may be travelling by a cab, metro or bus or be in your classroom or doctor's clinic or you may be on road or on airport lounge waiting for your flight, everywhere you would feel the presence of media. The moment you turn on your television set, you find a large number of 24-hour channels carrying news, reality shows, serials and movies. Movies are being made available on-demand from the Cable/DTH (Direct to Home) service providers. Videos are easily available online for streaming or downloading. You may sometimes ponder: How could we reach the present stage so quickly? The answer lies in a unit on history of mass media of this course.

We believe that text books have laid the foundation of educational media. Once upon a time, manuscripts were either engraved on palm leaves with the help of sharp wooden or metallic needle-type tools or written by hand on hand-made papers. If we compare two copies of the same text, they would not be exactly the same. It was continued until the movable type printing press was invented by Johann Gutenberg in 15th-century. After 'Printed Text Book', 'Newspapers' have the full potential to be described as Educational Media.

Then came the non-print media (or you may say electronic media). The first major non-print media-Film and Radio, gained popularity in the early decades of the 20th century. Radio became popular during 1920s as a large number of people were able to listen to the same event at the same time. The post-World War II era could see the introduction of a new form of mass communication: television in the United States. Broadcast television was the dominant form of mass media. Film, Television & Radio-can be called as Educational Media depending on their usage and users. Teachers and parents often blame Film, Television & Radio for showing the content they don't approve of. That is the reason we have started using the term like "Educational Television", "Educational Radio" and "Educational Film" to give an identity to these media to be considered as Educational Media. But it is true that no media can be compared to another media. It is like 'comparing Apple with Orange'. Each media has its own strength and weakness. Print Media has an advantage over Broadcast Media as far as its 'durability' in terms of 'storage' and 'flexibility' in terms of time are concerned. Newer media would

evolve further with the changing and pressing need of our society. But it all depends on us how to designate them as “Educational Media”.

Check Your Progress 1

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. According to you, how do you like to define ‘Educational Media’? (Within 100 words).

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2. What is the difference between ‘Educational Media’ and ‘Educational Technology’? Give some examples to support your answer (Within 100 words).

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3. It is like ‘Comparing Apple with Orange’-what does it mean in the context of ‘Educational Media’? (Within 100 words).

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14.3 EDUCATIONAL MEDIA IN INDIA

Government of India is deeply committed to enhance the reach of and access to education all over the country. If we look around for a perfect tool to reach the unreached and to ensure the education to be at door step of the aspiring learners then the electronic media like Radio, Television and Internet could be considered as the potential medium. Particularly, the role of educational broadcasting on Radio and Television and webcasting on Internet is extremely important in order to cope with pressing educational needs and to deliver a high standard (Agrawal, 2000) of skill-oriented education. Although, “Democratisation of education” is an important issue with regard to the use of educational broadcast but many researcher claim that limited evidence is there to support that educational broadcasting has really helped towards increasing either access or quality of education in India (Agrawal, 2000). As a student of mass media, you may like to think over this important issue and provide some innovative ways to use media for educating the masses.

14.3.1 Educational Media Scenario

India, having linguistic and cultural diversity, was recommended to follow multiple educational approaches. According to Binod C. Agrawal, an eminent media expert, “*Educational broadcast in India appeared as a result of strong recommendations by international agencies and communication experts from North America.*” (Agrawal, 2005).

From the very beginning, both “instruction” and “social education” were included in the educational broadcast. Much before Television came into existence in India, Radio was the first electronic media through which educational broadcasting was also attempted for almost three decades. But interestingly, it was never resolved by the academicians and educational policy makers “whether educational broadcast can be used directly without teacher intervention (Agrawal, 2000)”. Despite the fact that some stand-alone educational media (both broadcast and non-broadcast) have been created as private and public initiatives, the use of educational media is not very impressive so far.

14.3.2 Spectrum of Educational Media: Print vis-à-vis Electronic Media

By this time, you must have understood that it would not ever be fair on our part ‘to shoot the messenger’ instead of blaming the ‘sender’ who sends the ‘message’ with his/her own interpretation. Therefore, it all depends on ‘how we use a particular media’ in order to attach a well-defined meaning to it so that the medium in use may be called as an ‘Educational Medium’ in its full right. We all know that ‘Print’ medium has been used for ages to educate people. That is the reason; it is felt that it would be more appropriate for us to exclude ‘Print’ from the scope of our discussion and focus on the land marks created by various electronic media in the field of education.

Radio

“This is All India Radio.” Can you recall when you heard it last? This is the beginning announcement which is being made by an announcer before any programme to be broadcast on All India Radio (AIR). Next question: How frequently do you listen to Radio? Very less. Not only you, most of us have already forgotten our old Radio set. Although, the presence of Radio is very less, now-a-days, at our home, particularly in urban areas, Radio is still considered to be fairly old in India. Sound broadcasting started in India in 1927 with the proliferation of private radio clubs. The operations of All India Radio began formally in 1936 as a government organisation, with clear objectives *to inform, educate and entertain the masses*. After almost seven decades of government control, All India Radio was made an autonomous government-supported broadcasting body known as Prasar Bharati. India’s first full-fledged educational radio station, Gyan Vani (Voice of Knowledge), was started in 2002 (Agrawal, 2005).

Television

National television, known as *Door Darshan*, is another division of Prasar Bharati (Public Service Broadcasting Corporation of India) like AIR. *Door Darshan* has a three tier programme services—National, Regional and Local. *Door Darshan* had a modest beginning with an experimental telecast starting in Delhi on 15th

September 1959 with a small transmitter and a make shift studio. In 1982, Door Darshan as a National Broadcaster came into existence.

Film

The Indian film industry is being considered, almost for a century, as the world's largest Feature film-producing country (Agrawal, 2005). Although, the Film is an expensive medium, in the past many documentaries were produced on Film. Films are made on various subjects including popularisation of Science. Video, being a cheaper medium as compared to film, has been increasingly used to produce documentaries, limiting the use of 16-mm film, even for documentaries (Agrawal, 2005).

Satellite Services

Satellite services have been used in India for almost four decades now. During 1975–1976, Satellite Instructional Television Experiment (SITE), the world's largest techno-social experiment, was carried out in India (Agrawal, 2005). In a way, this event has laid the foundation of Indian broadcasting and telecommunication services. The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has been launching its own geo-stationary satellites from Indian soil. The Indian National Satellite (INSAT) system has played a significant role for the large-scale expansion of television. All India Radio is also using satellite services for digital broadcasting.

Educational Satellite (EDUSAT), launched in 2004, is the first Indian Satellite designed and developed exclusively for serving the educational sector. It is mainly intended to meet the demand for an interactive satellite based distance education system. It is a collaborative project of the Ministry of Human Resource Development (MHRD), Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), Department of Space and IGNOU.

14.3.3 Educational Broadcast: Gyan Darshan & Gyan Vani

Gyan Darshan

A 24-hour educational television channel, known as Gyan Darshan (GD) (Agrawal, 2005), was launched on January 26, 2000 in India. It was considered to be a major milestone in the field of educational broadcasting in India as a joint venture between the Ministry of Human Resources Development and Information and Broadcasting, Prasar Bharati and IGNOU. Gyan Darshan, a fully digital exclusive Educational TV Channel, was a digital bouquet of 4 channels-GD-1 (Prime Channel), GD-2 (Interactive Distance Education Channel), GD-3 (Ekalavya-Technology Education Channel) and GD-4 (Vyas-Higher Education Channel). Nevertheless, due to some financial, administrative and technical reason, this bouquet of *Gyan Darshan* channels was off-air on June 4, 2014 and it was back on-air on October 4, 2017, after more than 3yrs.

Gyan Vani

Gyan Vani is an educational FM Radio Channel, operating through FM stations from various places in the country. It is a joint venture of Ministry of Human Resource Development and Ministry of information & Broadcasting, Prasar Bharti and IGNOU with IGNOU being the nodal agency. The unique feature of Gyan Vani is its 'interactive mode' for enhancing and supplementing the learning process of the end users. Gyan Vani FM stations operate as 'media cooperative' consisting of various educational institutions and other agencies (Agrawal, 2005). IGNOU

hour programmes are telecast daily on Gyan Vani and their timings of broadcast varies in different Gyan Vani stations spread across the country.

Check Your Progress 2

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. 'Reaching the Unreached'- Do you think that 'Educational Media', particularly in India, has the potential to meet this objective? (Within 100 words).

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2. What are the different kinds of non-print 'Educational Media'? Give an example of Electronic Media which you consider as an 'Educational medium'. Give reasons for that. (Within 100 words).

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3. Do you agree that 'Educational Broadcast' in India has taken a lead role in the area of educating the mass-with a reference to Door Darshan, Gyan Darshan & Gyan Vani? (Within 100 words).

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14.4 USE OF EDUCATIONAL MEDIA IN TEACHING AND LEARNING

According to *Sir John Daniel*, former President and CEO, Commonwealth of Learning, former, Vice-Chancellor, The Open University, United Kingdom and former, Assistant Director-General for Education, UNESCO as he writes (Daniel, 2005):

"Educational media have the potential to transform the process of teaching and learning. We have seen their impact most dramatically through the emergence of large distance-teaching universities (open universities). We can learn much, in particular, from the way that these institutions deploy a variety of educational media that include radio, television, teleconferencing, interactive radio, multimedia and the Web."

This opinion of *Sir John Daniel* may motivate you to know more about the role of Educational Media in facilitating the process of teaching and learning with regard to the type of content that a particular medium does carry, the kind of approach adopted while using a medium (or a range of media) as well as the policy of the government towards making those media available to the learners easily and cost-effectively.

14.4.1 Educational Media in School Education and Higher Education

So far, we have understood that each media has the potential to be designated as 'Educational Media' but it all depends on the user (most of the time, happens to be a teacher or academician) who should identify the pedagogical issues involved in the teaching-learning process and exploit strength of the medium to facilitate learning. You too might have noticed while reading this unit that, time and again, the media experts and technologists are of opinion that a teacher can play an important role as a 'change agent' towards using various media in the class room or even beyond the class room. You can find many video clips uploaded on YouTube which can be used as a tool to create a favourable teaching-learning environment.

However, these video clips may not be used on broadcast mode without due permission of the source (person/agency) as most of these clips are having copy right issue. You may also create such small clips of your own to clarify various concepts with the help of some technicians. Sometimes, a video can substitute a 'Site Visit' which a teacher might be planning to organise.

14.4.2 Educational Media in Open and Distance Education

Today, open and distance learning has emerged as a major mode of acquiring knowledge and imparting education and training to heterogeneous groups (Agarwal, 2005) of people spread all over the country. In the system of open and distance learning, different types of media and technologies are being used to reach at the door step of the learners. According to Rumble, four media namely print, audio, television and computer are available for teaching purposes, in one technological form or another (Rumble, 1986, Rumble, 1995). On the contrary, Prof. Bates (Bates, 1995; Bates, 1993) has identified five important media in education: direct human contact (face to face), text (including still graphics), audio, television and computing. The use of each media gives both variety and the chance of accommodating different learning styles. At the same time, we cannot afford to ignore the various logistics like availability of the required infrastructure and financial resources. It is true that during a short span of time, "distance education has evolved from print-based media to Web-enabled media" (Agrawal, 2005).

14.4.3 Use of Educational Media at IGNOU

The Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU), the only National Open University, caters to the needs of millions of learners spread all over the country by offering courses at Certificate, Diploma, Bachelor's Degree, Master's Degree and Doctoral Degree levels. IGNOU, the world's largest university, was established by an Act of Parliament in 1985, 'to advance and disseminate learning and knowledge by a diversity of means, including the use of communication technology' (IGNOU Profile, 2015). In line with the objectives of the University, it has adopted an integrated strategy for imparting instruction, consisting of print materials,

audio-video tapes, broadcast on radio, educational TV channels, teleconferencing, video conferencing and also the face- to- face counselling at its study centres located throughout the country and overseas.

The preparation of audio and video programmes is undertaken at the Electronic Media Production Centre (EMPC) of the university. IGNOU has taken up a number of new initiatives to enrich learning experiences as a part of its media strategy. It is encouraging to share, collaborate and provide convergence for seamless access to learning (Agarwal, 2005).

Check Your Progress 3

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. 'Pedagogy should be the heart of any educational technology'-Explain this statement with reference to Educational Media. (Within 100 words).

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2. 'Water Crisis in a Metro during Hot Summer days'-if you want to produce a piece on video on this topic to be used in a classroom of 12th Standard, then what steps you would like to follow? (Within 100 words).

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3. What is the 'Educational Media Strategy' at IGNOU? Please visit any State Open University or Distance Learning Institutes which is nearest to your place and gather information about different types of educational media which are being used there. (Within 100 words).

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14.5 INNOVATIVE USE OF EDUCATIONAL MEDIA

Innovative educational technology might represent a completely new way of teaching, or it can reflect a better way to use an existing teaching tool ("Examples of Innovative Educational Technology", n. d.).

Educational Media in India namely Print, Radio and Television are well established. Besides these traditional media, a relatively emerging medium like Internet has enabled computer to be used in diversified fields including education. Mobile telephony is another powerful technology which can help us make people aware and train school students about important issues like HIV/AIDS. Some innovative strategies towards using Educational Media for HIV/AIDS awareness and training to school students and their parents/teachers have been adopted in India and worldwide (Misra, 2012).

14.5.1 Future of Educational Media

The future of Educational Media using ICT is very much associated with three major challenges (Ramamurthy, 2006): affordable connectivity, effective Machine-user Interaction in an environment of multiple languages, illiteracy and limited mobility and conversion of the “content receivers” into “content generators”. As far as addressing the third challenge is concerned—converting the content receiver into a content producer, V.S. Ramamurthy, former Secretary, Department of Science & Technology, Government of India had cited an interesting example of a fishing village. According to him, in a fishing village a fisherman would be interested to know the sea surface conditions—whether they could venture out in the deep sea or whether the sea would be tough. Such information could be made available. On the contrary, some information need to be locally generated, for e.g. what is the cost of fish in local market. Ramamurthy insisted that this has to originate from the villages and reach the villagers. He hoped that after getting the information, a fisherman could get the best price by taking the catch to an appropriate market place.

Check Your Progress 4

Note: 1) Use the space provided below for your Answers.
2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of the unit.

1. What do you mean by the innovative use of Educational Technology? Give an example to illustrate your point? (Within 100 words)

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2. Give some Examples of the innovative use of ‘Educational Media’ in Indian Context. Discuss how educational media can help in making people aware of HIV? (Within 100 words)

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14.6 LET US SUM UP

In this unit we began by discussing the evolution of Educational Media in which we tried to define Educational Media taking its various aspects into our discussion. Further, we also explained the difference between Educational Media and Educational Technology.

Next, we made an attempt to trace the growth of Educational Media in India in which we specifically discussed about educational broadcast with a special reference to Gyan Darshan & Gyan Vani. During our discussion, we had provided an overview of the spectrum of educational media starting from Print to Electronic.

We have elaborately discussed regarding the effective use of Educational Media in teaching and learning. We tried to highlight the strategy of using Educational Media at Indira Gandhi National Open University, India in the context of using them in Open and Distance Education. Finally, we emphasised upon the importance of using Educational Media innovatively by giving various examples which are in practice in the national and international scenario. We highlighted the role of ICT and new media providing updated and instantaneous information for the benefit of the common citizen. We can see a great future ahead as far as the applicability of 'Educational Media' is concerned.

14.7 FURTHER READINGS

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<http://edcetera.rafter.com/7-steps-to-create-engaging-educational-media/>. (n.d.). *7 Steps to Create Engaging Educational Media..* Available at:

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14.8 CHECK YOUR PROGRESS: POSSIBLE ANSWERS

Check Your Progress 1

1. (**Hint:** Try to define 'Educational Media' in today's scenario e.g. you may call either 'Television' or Radio or even Print as an Educational Medium which fulfils all the conditions to be called so.
2. (**Hint:** 'Educational Media' are Text Books, Magazines, Film, Audio/Video Programmes whereas 'Technology' is like Computer, TV, Digital Cameras and so on. You may look around and try to identify any technology which is different to the Media which has adopted the particular technology)

3. **(Hint:** Every media has advantages and disadvantages. Like Orange and Apple have their own unique nutritional values, each media has its strength and weakness.)

Check Your Progress 2

1. **(Hint:** The main objective of any Educational Medium should be reaching the grass root level by educating and empowering the mass with regard to health, employment and so on. Try to read newspapers or watch the TV News and highlight the latest break-through.
2. **(Hint:** Highlight all the components towards the formation of the Spectrum of Educational Media.)
3. **(Hint:** Watch either IGNOU Broadcast or Country Wide Class Room of CEC-UGC on DD-1: Door Darshan National Network) or any other educational broadcast and make a list of things towards educating the audience or making them aware of important issues).

Check Your Progress 3

1. **(Hint:** With regard to the issue of 'Technology vs. Pedagogy', you may watch any medium and try to answer questions like: What you are listening to or watching in the classroom or beyond classroom, are they engaging you? Do you think that educational programme content is relevant for the audience? You may exclude yourself from the audience sometime as the programme is may not be meant for you?
2. **(Hint:** Keep a note book and visit the area where water crisis is acute to get the first hand issues for including in your programme).
3. **(Hint:** Visit any State Open University or Distance Learning Institutes which is nearest to your place and gather information about different types of educational media which are being used there.

Check Your Progress 4

1. **(Hint:** Look around and try to find out the same computer or TV or Radio broadcast which are being used differently in the field of education)
2. **(Hint:** Go to a nearest Hospital and find out how Print as well as Electronic media are being used for people making aware of various issues pertaining to health care including HIV.)